

29 Qualifying descriptions

There are many ways to qualify or add further detail to adjectives. Some types of adjectives can only be modified in certain ways.

-  **New language** Non-gradable adjectives
- Aa Vocabulary** Qualifying words
-  **New skill** Adding detail to descriptions

29.1 KEY LANGUAGE NON-GRADABLE ADJECTIVES

Most adjectives can be modified with grading adverbs, such as “slightly,” “very,” and “extremely.” Non-gradable adjectives cannot be modified in this way. These adjectives tend to fall into three categories: extreme, absolute, and classifying.

Gradable adjectives like “good” can be modified with grading adverbs like “extremely” and “very.”

Her arguments were extremely **good**.

Her arguments were **fantastic**!



Non-gradable adjectives like “fantastic” cannot be modified by grading adverbs.

EXTREME ADJECTIVES

Extreme adjectives are stronger versions of gradable adjectives, such as “awful,” “hilarious,” “fantastic,” or “terrifying.”

Her presentation was **awful**.

The sense of “extremely” is already incorporated here.

ABSOLUTE ADJECTIVES

Absolute adjectives cannot be graded because they describe fixed qualities or states, such as “unique,” “perfect,” or “impossible.”

She has a **unique** presenting style.

It is not possible for something to be more or less unique.

CLASSIFYING ADJECTIVES

Classifying adjectives are used to say that something is of a specific type or class, such as “American,” “nuclear,” or “medical.”

The audience was **American**.

